

AKENTEN APPIAH – MENKA UNIVERSITY OF SKILLS TRAINING AND ENTREPRENEURIAL

DEVELOPMENT

FACULTY OF APPLIED SCIENCES AND MATHEMATICS EDUCATION DEPARTMENT OF

MATHEMATICS EDUCATION



NAME	ODURO PRINCE
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SUPERVISOR	DR. RICHARD AMANKWAH

TEACHING PORTFOLIO 2026/2027**UNIVERSITY OF SKILLS TRAINING AND ENTREPRENEURIAL DEVELOPMENT
INSTITUTE FOR TEACHER PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND LIFELONG LEARNING (ITPDLL)****CONTENT**

1. Statement of Teaching Philosophy
2. Reflective Practice

PART ONE: TEACHING PHILOSOPHY**INTRODUCTION**

A teaching philosophy is a reflection of a teacher's personal beliefs and values about teaching and learning. It guides the delivery of subject content and specific techniques to achieve success. A well-defined teaching philosophy helps teachers stay focused on their goals and appreciate the personal and professional rewards of teaching (Oti-Agyen, 2012).

STATEMENT OF MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

My teaching philosophy is centered on a Student-Centered Learning Environment. I believe that for teaching to be effective and for its goals to be achieved, students should be fully involved in the teaching and learning delivery. I aspire to create student-centered learning environments where the student drives their own learning. My classroom is always focused on the specific needs of my students, and I work hard to differentiate learning to emphasize each student's unique skills. The principle of individual differences helps me teach systematically from known to unknown, recognizing that students are not *tabula rasa* but have unique contributions to their education.

As William Heard Kilpatrick (1918) asserted, the role of a teacher should be that of a guide, not a dictator of knowledge. Kilpatrick championed the idea that children should direct their own learning according to their interests and be allowed to explore their environment, experiencing learning through their natural senses.

VALIDITY

My teaching philosophy is grounded in the constructivist theory of learning proposed by Bruner (1990). According to this theory, *"learning is an active process in which learners construct their knowledge and ideas based upon their past*

or current knowledge." This approach asserts that students learn most effectively when they engage directly with problems and participate actively in finding solutions.

My philosophy also finds strong support in:

Theorist/Theory	Contribution
William Heard Kilpatrick (1918)	The Project Method emphasizes active, interest-driven learning through meaningful projects. Learners develop knowledge, initiative, responsibility, and collaboration skills.
John Dewey (1938)	Experiential Learning and Learner-Centered Education advocate for learning through experience, inquiry, and active involvement in real-world contexts.
Constructivist Learning Theory	Learners actively construct knowledge rather than passively receive it. Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD) emphasizes learning through social interaction and guided participation.
Farrant's Discovery Learning	<i>"Knowledge gained by self-effort and discovery is better assimilated and remembered than that which is merely memorized."</i>

When learners participate fully in classroom activities, they develop:

- Deeper understanding through processing, applying, and explaining concepts
- Greater confidence through their own efforts and success
- Critical thinking skills through analysis, evaluation, and creation
- Ownership of learning as active agents, not passive recipients
- Collaboration skills through working with others

APPLICATION

In applying my philosophy, I ensured that all my lessons were introduced with relevant previous knowledge that builds upon what learners already know. I also linked the lessons to real-life situations in order to promote active participation.

I guided my students to:

- Express themselves and accept themselves for who they are
- Embrace the differences of others
- Believe in themselves so they participate actively with no fear of being mocked or intimidated

I involved my students using:

- Discussion

- Demonstration
- Effective questioning and answers
- Cooperative group learning

Practical Example - Lesson at St. Augusten Senior High School:

In a recent lesson on Document Formatting delivered to 2 Arts A at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso, I applied my philosophy as follows:

Activity	Application
Introduction	Interactive discussion on the relevance of document formatting in academic and professional contexts.
Font Formatting	Learners explored font options through live demonstrations and practical exercises on computers.
Paragraph Formatting	Learners practiced alignment, line spacing, and indentation using short text passages.
Page Layout	Learners applied margins, orientation, and page size to their documents.
Tables	Learners created and formatted tables, inserting rows/columns, merging cells, and applying borders.
Application Task	Learners formatted a given document with appropriate settings and inserted a formatted table.

As Farrant notes, *"Knowledge gained by self-effort and discovery is better assimilated and remembered than that which is merely memorized."* By engaging learners in hands-on activities rather than passive listening, they developed practical skills that will serve them beyond the classroom.

EFFECTIVENESS

I can say that students' confidence in the subject of Information Communication Technology is higher and they are ready to study for not only exams but for the future as well. This was evident in their:

- Active participation in class with good contributions
- Scores in class exercises
- Assignments
- Mid-semester tests
- End of term examinations

Area	Evidence
Increased Interest	Learners developed greater engagement in the subject matter.
Deeper Understanding	Learners demonstrated ability to explain concepts in their own words and apply knowledge to new situations.
Improved Performance	Measurable improvement in class tests, assignments, and end-of-term examinations.
Confidence Building	Learners expressed their thoughts freely without fear of judgment.
Positive Culture	Classroom atmosphere became more respectful, collaborative, and supportive.

PRESENTATION

My teaching philosophy (Presentation) is that every learner can learn when lessons are simple, clear, and interesting. During my internship at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso, I explained lessons in a way that learners could understand. I used teaching and learning materials, asked questions, and encouraged learners to participate in class. I believe a good teacher should be patient, supportive, and create a friendly classroom where every learner feels free to learn and ask questions.

I align myself with John Comenius, who said: *"I seek the method that will make learners learn more and teachers teach less."* This ideal remains my guiding principle.

RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS/COMMENTS FROM TEACHER/SUPERVISOR

During my teaching practice at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso, I responded positively to questions and comments from my teacher and supervisor. I listened carefully to their feedback and used it to improve my teaching methods. I also asked questions when I did not understand something to help me become better. Their comments guided me to correct my mistakes and develop confidence in the classroom. I see feedback as an important part of my learning and professional growth as a teacher.

REFERENCES

- Bruner, J. (1990). *Acts of Meaning*. Cambridge: Harvard University Press.
- Dewey, J. (1938). *Experience and Education*. New York: Macmillan.
- Oti-Agyen, P. (2012). *Principles and Methods of Teaching*. Kumasi: Wilas Press.
- Vygotsky, L. S. (1978). *Mind in Society: The Development of Higher Psychological Processes*.

PART TWO: REFLECTIVE PRACTICE

INTRODUCTION

Reflective practice is a systematic process of critically examining teaching and learning experiences to improve future instruction. It involves evaluating lesson delivery, learner participation, teaching methods, and the achievement of instructional objectives (Schön, 1983). Through reflection, teachers identify strengths and weaknesses to enhance effective teaching and learning.

During my internship program at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso, I reflected on nearly every lesson. However, this account focuses on a Word Processing lesson on Document Formatting, delivered to 2 Arts A.

LESSON COVERAGE

Aspect	Details
Name of School	St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso
Department	Information Technology
Subject	Word Processing / IT Applications
Class	2 Arts A
Topic	Document Formatting (Fonts, Paragraphs, Page Layout, and Tables)
Duration	120 minutes

INSTRUCTIONAL OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, learners were expected to:

No.	Objective
1	Explain the purpose and importance of document formatting.
2	Apply font formatting options: bold, italic, underline, font size, and font color.

No.	Objective
3	Apply paragraph formatting options: alignment, line spacing, and indentation.
4	Create and format tables with borders, shading, and merged cells.

Relevant Previous Knowledge (RPK): Learners had prior knowledge of basic computer operations and typing skills from previous lessons, which facilitated their understanding of word processing concepts.

Teaching and Learning Materials (TLMs): Whiteboard, markers, projector, computers with Microsoft Word, sample documents, and handouts.

Mode of Delivery: I delivered the lesson through explanations, demonstrations, and practical's.

TEACHER-LEARNER ACTIVITIES

Introduction

The lesson began with an interactive discussion on the relevance of document formatting in academic and professional contexts. Learners were guided to understand that formatting enhances readability and ensures effective communication. This activated prior knowledge and established real-world relevance.

Development of the Lesson

I developed the lesson through activities:

- Step 1: Through questioning and live demonstrations, learners explored font formatting options (bold, italic, underline, font size, font color, font style). Learners practiced on their computers and copied notes.
- Step 2: I explained paragraph formatting options (alignment, line spacing, indentation, spacing before/after). Learners practiced using short text passages.
- Step 3: Learners were introduced to page layout settings (margins, orientation, page size, columns, page borders).
- Step 4: Learners created and formatted tables (inserting rows/columns, merging/splitting cells, applying borders and shading).
- Step 5: Learners completed a practical task: formatting a given document and inserting a formatted table.

CLOSURE

The lesson was summarized by revisiting key concepts. Learners responded appropriately to questions, demonstrating good comprehension.

STRENGTHS

No.	Strength
1	Clear and well-structured lesson delivery.
2	Effective integration of theory and practical application.
3	Active learner participation through hands-on activities.
4	Effective use of live demonstrations.
5	All instructional objectives were achieved.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

The lesson was successful since the instructional objectives were achieved. Nevertheless, these were some challenges I encountered:

No.	Challenge	Impact
1	Some learners struggled to locate specific formatting options in the software interface.	Delayed task completion and minor frustration.
2	Extended lesson duration (135 minutes) led to learner fatigue.	Reduced concentration in the final segment.
3	A few learners remained passive during discussions and group activities.	Unequal participation and engagement.
4	Table formatting (merging cells, adjusting columns) posed difficulties for some learners.	Incomplete practical tasks.
5	Limited computer access for some learners affected practice time.	Uneven skill development.

INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS

No.	Strategy	Rationale
1	Delivered step-by-step demonstrations using a projector.	Visual guidance improves software skill acquisition.
2	Provided quick-reference handouts with keyboard shortcuts.	Supports independent learning and retention.
3	Incorporated short breaks and varied questioning techniques.	Maintains engagement over extended periods.
4	Encouraged peer-to-peer support and paired activities.	Builds confidence and promotes collaborative learning.
5	Offered differentiated support and additional practice exercises.	Addresses individual learner needs.
6	Rotated learners through available computers.	Maximizes hands-on practice time for all students.

LESSONS AND INSIGHTS GAINED

I realized that:

No.	Insight	Application for Future Practice
1	Effective questioning enhances participation and understanding.	Continue to employ varied questioning techniques.
2	Hands-on practice is essential for developing practical IT skills.	Prioritize learner-centered, activity-based approaches.
3	Visual demonstrations significantly improve comprehension.	Use projectors and visual aids consistently.
4	Time management is critical for extended lessons.	Build in structured breaks and vary activities.

No.	Insight	Application for Future Practice
5	Peer collaboration benefits passive learners and builds confidence.	Incorporate more pair-work and group activities.
6	Differentiated instruction addresses varying learner abilities.	Provide leveled tasks and individual support.
7	Real-world relevance motivates learners and increases engagement.	Use practical examples whenever possible.
8	Proper planning is essential for managing extended lesson durations.	Continue systematic lesson evaluation.

PRESENTATION OF SEMINAR

During my presentation seminar at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso, I presented my lesson to my supervisor and colleagues. I prepared well and used teaching materials to support my lesson. After the presentation, I received feedback that helped me improve. The seminar helped me to build confidence and improve my teaching skills. I have learned to always prepare well and accept corrections for improvement.

RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS/COMMENTS FROM STUDENTS/SUPERVISOR

From Students: The students said the lesson was clear and easy to understand, and they enjoyed the practical work. They also said the teacher explained well.

From Supervisor: The supervisor commented that the teaching was good and the explanation was clear, but I should improve my hand writing and involve all learners in the lesson.

CONCLUSION

Reflective practice is essential for professional growth. This lesson on Document Formatting at St. Augusten Senior High School, Bogoso reinforced the importance of interactive teaching strategies, hands-on practice, visual demonstrations, and effective time management. Through continuous reflection, I am able to identify my strengths and areas for improvement, which will guide me in delivering more effective and engaging lessons in the future.